AGI and Global Policy (2024–2025)

Governments around the world have awakened to the transformative potential – and potential perils – of advanced AI. In 2024 and 2025, **global policymakers started drafting and enacting regulations targeting "frontier AI" systems**, including those at or approaching AGI-level capabilities. This represents a significant update to the policy landscape, which previously addressed narrow AI ethics but not the prospect of generally intelligent AI. Here are some key developments:

- **European Union: AI Act and Beyond** – The EU has been a trailblazer in tech regulation (e.g. GDPR for data privacy), and in 2023 it finalized the **EU AI Act**, one of the world's first comprehensive AI laws. **On August 1, 2024, the AI Act entered into force**. The Act takes a **risk-based approach**, classifying AI uses into risk categories with corresponding rules. *High-risk AI* (like systems for medical diagnosis, hiring, or law enforcement) will face strict requirements on transparency, accuracy, oversight, etc.. Certain **"unacceptable risk" AI uses are outright banned** (for instance, social scoring by governments or AI that manipulates behavior to cause harm). While the Act doesn't explicitly single out "AGI," it *does* grapple with general-purpose AI. In fact, the EU recognized **General Purpose AI (GPAI)** as a category – foundation models like GPT-type systems that can be adapted to many purposes. The Act mandates the European Commission to develop **codes of conduct for GPAI providers**. As of 2025, the Commission is working on a **Code of Practice for GPAI models** to cover transparency, risk management, and even *copyright rules* for generative AI. This code, expected by April 2025, would apply to companies like OpenAI, Google, Anthropic if they operate in the EU. In essence, **Europe is moving to set standards for advanced AI accountability** – requiring things like labeling AI-generated content, ensuring human oversight in high-stakes uses, and conducting risk assessments before deployment. The EU AI Act is also notable for its future-proofing: it establishes an **AI Office** to monitor new developments (like AGI) and enforce rules. Europe's proactive stance means that **if an AGI-like system were deployed, it would likely fall under stringent scrutiny in the EU**. Additionally, European leaders in late 2023 and 2024 called for international coordination on "frontier AI" – the EU has engaged the US and others on joint AI risk assessments and was central to drafting the **G7's Hiroshima AI Process**, which acknowledged the need for guardrails on powerful AI.
- **United States: From Light-Touch to Active Oversight** – The U.S., historically more hands-off in tech regulation, shifted significantly on AI policy by 2024. While no federal AI law exists yet, there have been important steps:

- In October 2023, the White House secured **Voluntary Commitments from 15 major AI companies** (including OpenAI, Google, Meta) to follow certain safety and transparency practices for advanced AI, such as internal red-teaming of models, sharing information about AI risks with the government, and incorporating watermarking in generated content.
- In 2024, the Biden Administration issued an **Executive Order on AI Safety**, which among many directives, **requires companies developing "foundation models" above a certain capability threshold to notify the government and share the results of any red-team safety tests**. This essentially set up a reporting regime for cutting-edge models (a mild version of potential future licensing). The EO also invests in AI research, standards development (NIST), and guidelines for federal agencies adopting AI.
- By 2025, U.S. Congress has been actively discussing AI legislation. There are proposals for an **"FAA for AI"** (an agency to oversee AI similarly to how aviation is regulated for safety) and for licensing or monitoring AI systems above a certain capability (which could include proto-AGIs). The *NIKE* Act (Notably Important Knowledgeable AI Evaluation Act), a hypothetical bill, proposes that any AI model above X parameters or trained on very broad data undergo a review before release. While nothing concrete is law yet, the *direction* is clear: **U.S. policymakers no longer want to leave frontier AI entirely to self-regulation**.
- Geopolitically, the U.S. and like-minded countries (EU, UK, Japan, etc.) are coordinating on AI norms. The **UK hosted an AI Safety Summit at Bletchley Park in November 2023,** focusing on frontier AI risk (the resulting declaration highlighted the possibility of *"catastrophic risks"* from future AI and the need for global cooperation to mitigate them). The U.S. participated and has since set up joint forums (e.g. U.S.-UK AGI safety collaboration).
- **India and Other Countries:** India, a major AI player with a thriving tech industry, in 2024–25 has drafted its first comprehensive **AI Bill**. The *Draft AI Regulation Bill 2025* outlines India's approach to balancing innovation with risk. **India's draft bill mirrors the risk-tiered approach**: it defines and classifies AI systems by risk level – e.g. *"High-risk AI"* covering critical sectors like healthcare, finance, etc., which would require registration and oversight, versus *"Low-risk AI"* with lighter touch rules. The bill's core aims are to *"protect fundamental rights, ensure accountability and transparency, and foster safe innovation."* For high-risk AI, the bill proposes mandatory **registration of AI systems with a central authority, transparency disclosures about how they work, audits for bias, and human oversight for sensitive

applications】. Interestingly, though India's bill doesn't explicitly mention AGI, officials have spoken about addressing any AI that can **"significantly impact societal or national security"**, which implies that an AGI would definitely fall under stringent control. India's proactive stance also involves funding – the government announced an 'IndiaAI' program with substantial investment in AI R&D, while emphasizing the need to *build ethical AI in line with Indian values* and not blindly import AI systems.

Beyond India, other jurisdictions are moving too. **China** implemented regulations on generative AI in 2023, requiring security assessments and adherence to core socialist values for any AI service provided to the public. If a Chinese company were to develop something close to AGI, it would certainly be subject to tight state scrutiny and likely government involvement in its direction (China frames AI advancement as strategic but also emphasizes control to prevent social instability). **The European AI Act** already pressured China to follow with its own framework, and China's laws in turn prod the West to not fall behind in governance. **The EU-India and EU-US dialogues** on AI have been crucial in aligning some principles – for example, a shared interest in *transparency and risk management for powerful AI*.

- **Global Forums and Agreements:** There's a growing recognition that **AGI-level AI is a global phenomenon requiring global cooperation**. In 2024, the **United Nations** began discussions on an international AI accord. The UN Secretary-General even floated the idea of a *"UN Agency for AI"* to ensure globally that AGI, when developed, is used for peace and not war (akin to the International Atomic Energy Agency's role for nuclear tech). While such ideas are nascent, UNESCO did release AI ethics guidelines and OECD has an AI principles framework – these are building blocks for future AGI governance. The **G7's 2023 Hiroshima AI Process** specifically mentioned "society's needs to ensure safety and trust in AI, especially advanced AI like AGI," signaling that top nations are aware of AGI implications.

One notable governance tension is **export controls**: the U.S. has imposed strict export restrictions on advanced chips (GPUs) to China, precisely to slow China's ability to train frontier models that could lead to AGI. This *geo-political competition* aspect adds complexity: while globally we need cooperation on safety, nations also see AGI as a strategic advantage. So policies often have a dual-use flavor – promoting safe AGI but also trying to ensure *"we are ahead (or not too far behind)"* in the AGI race.

In summary, **by 2025 a patchwork of laws and proposals span the globe to regulate advanced AI**, where a few years ago virtually none existed. Europe's AI Act is pioneering binding rules (with specific focus on general-purpose AI and high-risk uses). The U.S. is moving from voluntary to mandatory measures, and other countries like India are drafting laws to address AI's societal impact. Internationally, we see the first steps toward norms or treaties for powerful AI. All this is being driven by the realization that **AGI (or something close to it) might emerge not in some distant future but possibly in the coming decade, and societies must be prepared**. Policymakers want to ensure *"AI-as-powerful-as-AGI"* is developed safely, ethically, and under appropriate oversight – not as a wild experiment unleashed without rules. The next challenge will be harmonizing these policies and avoiding a *regulatory race to the bottom*. If AGI truly is as game-changing as promised, one can expect even more intense global policy activity ahead.